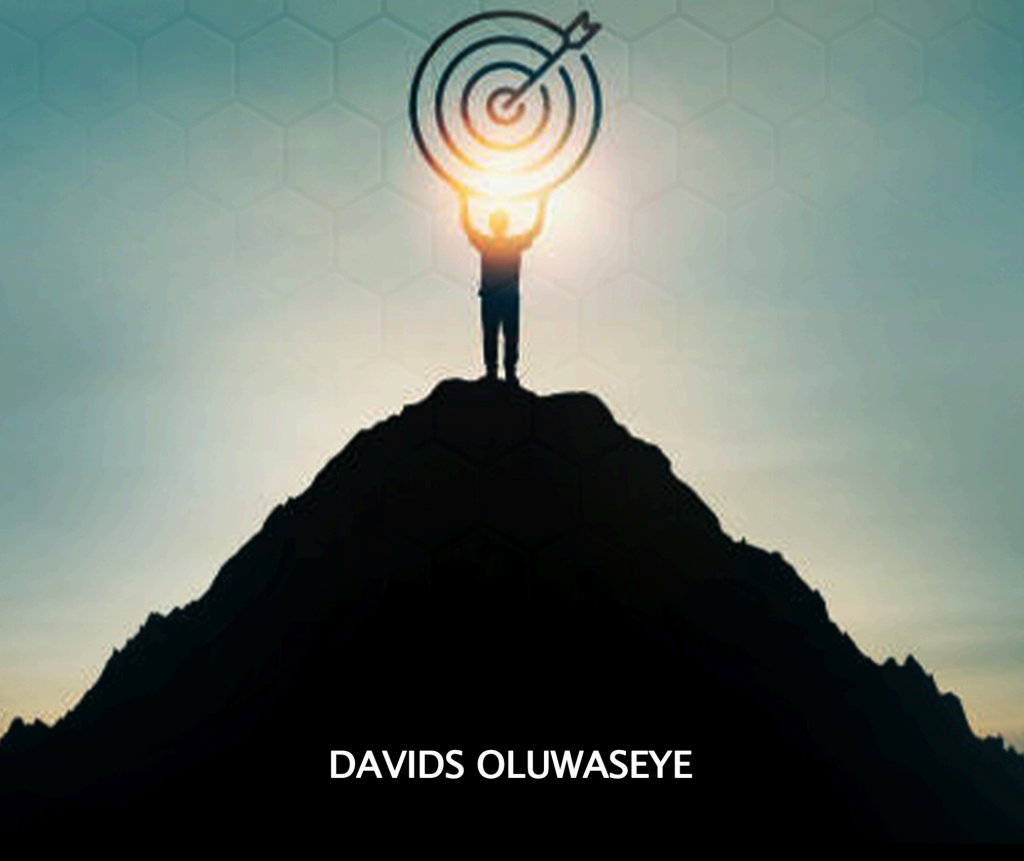
THE LIFE ASSIGNMENT



DAVIDS OLUWASEYE

THE LIFE ASSIGNMENT

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Times and Seasons of Life

Wisdom for Living

31 Wisdom Keys

The Meditations Series

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ISBN: 978-978-60850-0-5
Library of Congress Number: 978-978-60850-0-5
First edition: September 2024

Cover Design by Precious Abayowa
Layout by Precious Abayowa

Published in Nigeria by
The Wisdom Publications
thewisdomplaceonline@gmail.com
www.thewisdomplaceonline.com

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Acknowledgement

This book is not just written, it was taught and lived. I had the privilege of mentoring an exceptional team of young men and women over different times on certain onsite and online platforms. It is relevant parts of the content that we taught over the years at these platforms that were worked into the Wisdom for Living Book Series, of which this book is the first. I want to appreciate these uncommon proteges and everyone at the Wisdom Place, House of Insights, and other platforms, most of whom were the first set of students to learn the insights contained in the pages of this book.

The importance of a purpose-driven team to any project cannot be overestimated. The resourceful team which kept me accountable, while doing their quota in ensuring the success of this book includes Precious Akintunde with whom I co-wrote this book. He has a lot of original ideas in various chapters of the book. The team of contributors and editors was led by Otiti Aburime and includes Rachael Oyetade, Blessing Kayode, Ifejesu Majua Odejide and Precious Abayowa who also did the design of this book. Most of the team are also co-instructors with me at The Wisdom Place, The House of Insights and other platforms where I minister.

I do not trivialise the sacrifice of my family in allowing me to do all I do. To my ever loving wife, OluwaNifemi, thank you for your understanding and support. To my adorable sons, Wonders and Wisdom, your lives keep encouraging me never to give up.

Dedication

For in Him I live, and move, and have my being (Acts 17:28). This Book is dedicated to Jesus, the King of the Kingdom.

To my mentors and various persons who have been instrumental in launching forth this ministry; Pst Sunday Okoh and Pst Temple Omolehin. Our pastors; Apostle Muyiwa Areo and Pastor Temitope Areo, we thank God for the gift of you.

I appreciate God the Father for His Love, Jesus the Son, for His Grace and the Lord Holy Spirit for His Fellowship.

Davids Oluwaseye Ayodele

Preface

In the journey of success, the adventures and experiences along the path are more beneficial and vital, oftentimes, than the perks of arrival at the destination. Thus, in the quest for success, the attributes and attitudes one develops and what one becomes due to the demands of the journey are more profound, lasting and beneficial than the things one acquires for getting to the destination.

Like all journeys to the unknown, the value of a tour guide in the journey of success is immeasurable. Wisdom is the principal guide in the journey of life. At every point, Wisdom tells what to do, which way to go, where to take a bend, when to halt, with whom to and not to walk, and guides on many other crucial decisions in the course of the journey. Wisdom prevents one from errors thereby increasing one's chances of safe arrival to destiny.

The Wisdom of God is the foundation upon which the entire universe is built. Therefore, access to Divine Wisdom is like having the architect who designed the plans of a very complex mansion to show one around the building. One can not miss the way when the designer of the blueprint is also the guide.

This book focuses on Wisdom particularly in the context of achieving success in your life, vision, and destiny. The principles outlined are both straightforward and deep, rooted in God's Word. The insights shared in this book aim to motivate, push boundaries, spark creativity, and illuminate the path for you to reach your full potential.

CHAPTER 1

Understanding Self-Discovery and Self-Perception

Succeeding from the Inner Self

All true success flows from inside out. Success and greatness is more as a result of internal attributes than external conditions. This is the reason that two people can have exact external circumstances from birth till adulthood and turn out with life outcomes as different as the North pole from the South. It is a fact that two people can be born in the same location, by the same parents, go to the same schools, taught by the same teachers and one turns out a failure and the other a success. Whenever this happens, then there is necessarily somewhere along the life journey of such people that one must have got access to certain information, people, event or things that conditioned his/her inner realities differently from the other. If we carefully review the lives of such people, we would be able to somehow somewhere account for how the successful person made certain decisions or was exposed to certain environments, people, information or events that constructed his/her inner self differently from the failed people. The success or failure of each of these persons in our study must definitely have flowed from their inner realities.

Thus, all endeavors at making people successful must target their inner conditioning before their outward manifestation. The most important elements in attaining success are discovering, developing and actualizing one's inner potentials. The talk about the absolute importance of self-discovery and potential actualization seems to have been reduced to mere motivational cliche due to common talk by many. However, it is an eternal truth of life and cannot be disregarded. You will only be able to live a life of meaning when you discover your inner self and actualize your innate potential.

Therefore, investing in one's inner self, mind and spirit through reading empowering books like the one you are holding right now, acquiring advantageous information, relating with right people, exposure to enabling environments, developing superior thinking, beliefs, paradigms and spirituality remain the timeless pathway to success.

The Myth of Self Discovery

Self discovery is the prerequisite for success and fulfillment in life. However, the concept of self-discovery has been largely misunderstood. The popular talk about self-discovery, especially among secular speakers and environments many times, leaves people more confused than oriented. This is because many of the self-help theorems and strategies postulated seek to fix from outside an issue that need to be addressed from the inner self.

To really understand the concept of self-discovery, we need to go back to the first reference to the human-self in scriptures. In Gen 1:26-27, God said,

"***Let us make man in our image, in our likeness . . . So God created man in his own image, in the image of God he created him; male and female he created them.***

Humanity was made in the image and likeness of God - this truth is fundamental to self-discovery. Believing anything less puts one at risk of confusion. Primarily, being made in the image and likeness of God talks about the fact that man (both male and female) was created a spirit in the order and class of God. Thus, the God-nature, His DNA, is in man by creation. Furthermore, being made in the image and likeness of God implies that there is the revelation of God that is fabricated into the created man which he is to reveal on earth. Thus, there is something about God that every created person represents and is to reveal to the world. Self discovery is simply knowing the dimension of God that you were created to reveal to your world.

Before the fall of man in Genesis Chapter three, there was never a discussion or need for self-discovery. Adam knew who he was, he knew what each of the animals was by a glance and he knew who Eve was at first sight. Adam and Eve knew that they were God's regents over the earth. They had a 'default' self-knowledge. Self discovery is simply 'non-default' self-knowledge. That is, taking a while to come to the awareness of something about yourself that has always been there. Self-discovery is a term used to describe knowing who you are and what you were created to do - "truths that are at home with you all the while". This is where many worldly self-help trainers and their victims, miss the rope.

They make self-discovery look like something people have to go to search for. Thereby, they engage people into a gear of endless fruitless search. Why do I have to go and look for me? Why do I need another human to describe “me to me”.

At the fall, man lost connection with God and became confused about his identity and purpose. The whole industry that has evolved around self and purpose discovery was necessitated by “The Fall”. The entire business and discourse of self-discovery are man’s attempt to look for his identity and purpose. There are currently a lot of postulations on how to know oneself, one’s abilities, purpose and life meaning by experts and professionals in the multi-billion dollar self-discovery industry. Truly, some of the tactics have some credit to them. However, discovery of identity and purpose is simplified when one goes back to God’s mind for the creation of man at the beginning.

You are the image and likeness of God - this is your identity. Of course, the image and likeness of God is infinite and can not be holistically expressed by human. Thus, God deposits a dimension and revelation of Himself into everything He created to reveal. Even inanimate objects have a particular revelation of God that are given to reveal (see Psa 19: 1-4, Rom 1: 19 - 20).

Every human is different and are all created in the image and likeness of God. This does not mean that God has multiple identities like one suffering from identity crises, this rather shows that God is multi-dimensional and every of His child is to display a dimension of God.

God is many things - a parent, teacher, inventor, artist, scientist, communicator, healer, entrepreneur, musician, leader, administrator, writer, counsellor, king, lord and so on. Thus, whatever you are, there is a dimension in God that resonates with that. Self discovery is simply discovering the dimension(s) of God that is captured your identity. This is achieved after you become connected to God through faith in Jesus Christ and then by seeking God and allowing Him to reveal to you the part of Himself that pertains to you. This means that self-discovery, especially for a child of God, is actually "God discovery". Simply put, self is the discovering from God of the dimension of Him that you were created to reveal to the world.

In scriptural doctrine, being created in the image and likeness of God is talking about the fact that God is a Spirit and humans are made a spirit like Him. However, it is absolutely important to know that the image of God, in application and revelation, talks about the varied dimensions of God that each of His child is to reveal in a unique way.

This understanding explains why two different people can be learning about God, reading the same Bible, being taught by same teachers under the same conditions, seeking God under the same environments, but are seeing different realities about God. This also explains why it is unwise to make the entire pursuit of your life being or doing what someone else is or doing, in a comparative or competitive way.

A teacher seeks God and finds doctrines, a business person seeks God and finds practical business principles, a preacher seeks God and sees sermons, and a musician seeks God and sees lyrics overflowing in melodies, an intercessor seeks God and sees prayer points, a leader/political inclined person seeks God and finds governance. An inventor seeks God and finds creativity. A thought leader seeks God and finds ideas. God is so vast and no one can know all of Him and all about Him. A good way to know who you are is to devote yourself to seeking God and see the revelations that He gives you about yourself. God in His sovereignty actually supervises the revelation of Himself that each person gets and makes it to be according to the uniqueness of His assignment and destiny for them. Thus, to discover yourself, first become connected to God through faith in Jesus Christ, then decide to be and celebrate what God created you to be. Also, be determined not to be intimidated in appreciating the importance of the dimension of God you represent.

Thereafter, be committed to seeking God and discovering Him. The only way to truly discover and know yourself is by seeking and knowing God. When you seek God, you find yourself. In other words, when you seek God, you find the particular dimension of Him that pertains to your destiny. The secret of self confidence and self esteem is loving, appreciating, celebrating and believing in the importance of the dimension of God that you represent on earth.

A school teacher with this understanding reveals God with such boldness as an Apostle over a Church congregation. After all, Jesus was both referred to as an Apostle and a Rabbi in the Bible. Rabbis are teachers in the Jewish culture, and the role is more akin to the role of a contemporary school teacher than a pastor in today's culture.

The simple secret of self-discovery is to grow in the revelation, understanding and character of God. The more you know Him, the more you know yourself. After all, you are made in His image and likeness. A lot of methodologies for self-discovery has been promulgated by experts and motivational trainers. Some of these strategies include *'taking inventory of your weaknesses and strengths','identifying your pain and pleasure points', 'identifying the things you do effortlessly and passionately' and questions like 'what would you love to do even if you are not paid?'* are often used as self-discovery tools.

While there is much credit and benefit to some of the self-help methodologies engaged in the world, the eternal tools for self and purpose discovery are an intimate walk with God, high investiture in prayers and the Word, growth in spiritual understanding especially about God's Kingdom and the practical principles of life from God's perspective, learning to identify and hear God's word and obeying in faith the instructions of God per time. Walking with God in faith and obedience leads along the path of destiny.

The Question of Self-Actualisation

Obviously, some people would be quick to question the concept of self discovery taught here and advocate that there are tons of Forbes wealthy people, accomplished leaders, world's successful figures, Fortune 500 business owners, that have been conglomerates that do not have a relationship with God and have discovered themselves and succeeded. 'How can you possibly claim the path to self-discovery is God-discovery when many people who do not believe in God have discovered their gifting and further utilised them to achieve unprecedented success without God?', they would ask.

Good questions produce good answers. However, there are some questions that the answer is an entire understanding and body of knowledge. The only way to get such answers is to be patient and open enough to listen to adequate explanation which can only be communicated by the body of teaching. The answer to comprehensive answer to the above question is the mindset which this book would have given as many as patiently and humbly learn to the end of it.

However, I will stimulate the questioning minds with three thoughts while we journey through this book into an accurate understanding of success, fulfillment and purpose and, therefore the full understanding that answers the question in their minds.

Point one; It is possible not to have a relationship with God and still harness one's most innate abilities and maximize its potentials in achieving material success. However, true success and self-actualisation is not merely material accomplishment. Hence, we can not conclude that those category of people have succeeded until we have understood what success is in the real sense of it. Understanding success from a more accurate and higher perspective is a major theme of this volume.

Point two; people can attain great material success by being aligned with the principles that make for success without self discovery. This is the reason you see some of them that are entrepreneurs build serial businesses in different spaces and niches and fields and succeed in them all. What is working for them is not self discovery but disciplined alignment with the principles of productivity, wealth and material success. Some highly successful people in a field have made statements that insinuate they would still have succeeded irrespective of the field they purpose. A contemporary accomplished leader in the Kingdom frequently remarks that he would have been successful even if he was a food seller. The truth is that diligence, focus, excellence, discipline, skill and productivity and some other virtues in a person produce material success irrespective of what they channel those virtues towards. Understanding these virtues was the theme of Volume One of Wisdom for Success. So, applying oneself to principles of success will produce great material results but the dimension of success that lies in fulfilling the essence of one's life and existence is possible only by self-discovery through God-discovery.

Point three; thus, a holistic understanding of true success and self-fulfillment, which is the aim of this volume, makes one realize that many of the who are the reference points for material success without self-discovery and self-actualization in God have neither truly discovered self nor really succeeded. They have only material wealth and human perception of success through compliance with the principles of value, productivity, impact and wealth. True success and self-actualization, when all is said and done, cannot be totally appraised on this side of eternity.

CHAPTER 2

The Mystery of Self Perception

Another vital element in attaining success is accurate self perception. After discovering who you are in God, it is important that you begin to see yourself from God's perspective. Self -perception talks about how you see yourself, which in turn governs how you think, what you say and your expectations from yourself and others. The first challenge of success and fulfillment would be the challenge of developing an accurate self-perception.

Jesus, at a crucial point during his earth-walk, asked His disciples, a crucial question, *"Who do people say that I am?"*
He had before this time declared who He was, but the claims He made about who He was did not go down well with some people. Even though, He knew who He was, He still wanted to know what perception of people about Him was. This was not so that He could get His self-identity or self-definition from their perception, but so that He could assertively correct the wrong perception about Him of people closest to Him.

The truth is that people's perception of you is important, especially the people who are closest to you in daily life and work. People's perception of you affects your chances of success in many ways.

Wrong, inappropriate or inadequate perception of your value by people needs to be intentionally managed and possibly corrected. This is because how people perceive you determines how they relate with you, their expectations about you, the level of opportunities, honour and rewards they offer you, their faith and investment into you, and their support or resistance to your vision.

Jesus asked his disciples who people thought He was and they answered by giving many inaccurate perceptions about Him. Truly, to a large extent, people's perception about you will be inaccurate and less than your actual value. They perceived Jesus to be Elijah, Jeremiah, John the Baptist, and some of these were great names. but Jesus' true identity and worth was far higher than all the mighty names mentioned. This shows that even those that perceive you well. may not perceive you as well as they should. It takes God for someone to correctly see the infinite greatness of your potential. Thus, when Peter perceived Jesus correctly, He quickly noted that this was only possible because God revealed it to him. Indeed, no one can truly know the vastness of your potential and destiny unless God tells it to them. So do not feel despised when people see you less than you are. It is human to perceive inaccurately, it is divine to perceive you correctly.

However, more important than other people's perception of you is your self-perception. In the Bible, Jewish leaders sent priests and Temple assistants from Jerusalem to ask John the Baptist who he was.

Their question was a test of his perception of himself. They suggested some identities which they wanted to put on him. They asked if he was Eijah, the long-awaited prophet or the Christ. John simply replied them, *"I am the voice shouting in the wilderness . . ."* It is important not to leave your life definition to people, situations, circumstances or fate. You need to know who you are and see yourself through the lens of who you truly are.

John's statement about himself was directly curled from the prophecy that had been given about him by Prophet Isaiah centuries before His birth. When asked who he was, He replied by giving the Word of God that had been given about Him. The only accurate source of self-perception is what God says about you. John defined himself in terms of the Word of God for his destiny and not based on his situation, profession or circumstance. It is wise not to define yourself based on extrinsic possessions, circumstantial happening or any other ephemeral standard. It is only right to define yourself only in terms of the prophecy God has told you about your destiny. If your self-perception is based on your background, bank balance, educational achievement, job and professional or life circumstances, you will see yourself less than you truly are. Obviously, what one sees in life is what one gets. Seeing yourself less than you are will lead to under-achievement of potential.

This is the reason you must define yourself by your future, vision, destiny, life-assignment and God's promise to you. When asked who you are, answer based on who God has promised you will become.

The Question of Self-Actualisation

The only acceptable basis for your self-perception is God's perception of you. Not even your perception of yourself, outside of God's word, and certainly not others' perception of you is accurate. It is only God who truly knows your actual value. Everyone around will value you wrongly; most times, below your actual value. You will, most certainly, value yourself wrongly too– yes, below what you are worth. God's perception of you is always higher than everyone's - including your - perception of you .

God spoke to a young guy named Jeremiah, *"before I formed you in the womb I knew you, before you were born I set you apart; I appointed you as a prophet to the nations."* However, Jeremiah's perception of himself was much less so he said *"Ah, Sovereign Lord," He said, "I do not know how to speak; I am only a child."*
God saw him as an international leader, He saw himself as a child. God saw him as a global voice, people saw him as a noise-maker, he saw himself as someone with no voice. God needed to spend ample time working on his perception of himself, before he could enter into his destiny as an international prophet. A man can never rise above his self-perception. Even God cannot make you successful if you continually see yourself a failure.

God's perception and definition of you is your true value. Who God created you to be, what He made you to do and the destiny God created to fulfill are what truly describes who you are. The first step in developing a healthy self-perception, self-esteem and confidence is to find out what God perceives and believes you to be.

Thereafter, correct your self-perception by adopting God's perception of you. Your Creator knows the capacity and ability of the human giga-machine he fabricated, therefore, God has a gigantic perception of your person and ability. Let this be the basis for your self-image, self-identity, self-definition and self-belief. This will lead to a healthy self-esteem. It will improve your perception of yourself, your productivity and success.

In fact, let me throw to you the question that was thrown to John.
'Who are you'?

In case, you have never realized how profound this question is, try answering it now.
'Who are you'?

Oops!
Now, don't escape this question by continuing reading, Stop! Stop!! Stop!!! Answer this question.
'Who are you?'

Don't mentally peruse this question, your success depends on it! Take a pen and a paper and write down your answer to this question.
'Who are you?'

Ask yourself this question "who am I?' and write the answer in a blank sheet

I am

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

If you attempted to answer this question, you will realize that it is simple question but difficult to answer. So, as you stop reading this book for a moment, take a break to really answer this question; 'Who am I?'

You probably answered this question by stating your profession, title, office, position, nationality, qualifications, certifications, family pedigree or where you work, school or live. Probably you said, 'I am a professor, doctor, pastor, engineer, guru, CEO, teacher, business man, president . . .' If you answered with any of the fore-listed, you have just attached your essence and entirety to an external parameter which may change. If you defined who you are by any of this above you are in serious danger.

If you answered, 'I am a doctor', then a good question to ask you is, 'who were you before you became a doctor'? A nobody? What if you lost your job or ability to be a doctor today, who then do you become? A nobody? If for whatever reason, you lose the position or status you occupy today, who then are you?

Do you now understand why people commit suicide when they lose their wealth, job, position etc? It is because of identity-crisis. They cannot imagine life without the position, status or possession that they have used as the definition of their entire essence.
'Who are you? 'is a question of self-definition, self-perception, self-esteem and life-assignment.

Read
(i) Matt 16:13-19 (ii) John 1:19-28 (iii) Jeremiah 1: 5 – 10

CHAPTER 3

Understanding Self-Definition

Definitions are always the first basis for clarifying and understanding any concept. At all levels of schooling, whenever a topic is to be taught, the teacher starts by giving a working definition of it. A good and simple definition makes a concept well-understood, clear, easily relatable and applicable. A vital part of understanding, discovering and maximising your life purpose is to have a working definition of your life. A life of impact starts with a clear and concise definition.

Self Definition is mentally articulating, verbally or textually expressing what you believe your life is all about. Self-Definition is defining in clear terms who you are and what you life is about. Self-discovery and accurate self-perception should be followed by a succinct self-definition.

Your self-definition should align with God's perception of you. You are not to define yourself by what you are going through or what you do. Don't be defined by your current state in life; your income, job, status or environment. You are to be defined by what God had in mind when He created you. You are who God says you are.

In making an eternal success out of your life, after self-discovery and having aligned your self-perception with God's perspective of you, the next step in success is to have a working life definition for your life.

John the Baptist was asked who he was, and he replied by giving them his life definition. John replied in the words of the prophet Isaiah: ***"I am a voice shouting in the wilderness, 'Clear the way for the Lord's coming!'"*** (John 1:23). John quoted this statement verbatim from the prophecy about his life in the Book of Isaiah 40: 3. Thus, John knew the Word of God that had gone ahead of him and he defined himself based on it. A vital foundation for understanding your life-essence and purpose is having a word from God about your life upon which you describe and define who you are. This is the only sure foundation of self discovery, self-awareness and self-confidence. Self-confidence comes from perceiving and believing in yourself from God's perceptive even when you do not look like it yet.

Your self-definition is the statement you hold as the description your destiny, it is who you believe you are and what you believe you are to do with your life, based on what God has revealed to you about your life. It must be sourced in God's promises, prophecies or scripture for you. These scriptures you must have received, internalized, and believed so strongly in your heart that it has become a concrete consciousness and reality to your inner-self.

Your working definition of yourself must be so real to you that contrary people, status, situations, and circumstances cannot make you believe otherwise.

Life Scriptures

Furthermore, it is absolutely important that you have scriptures in your spirit that you have received and are convinced that they are direct descriptions of your destiny. The concept of having "Life Scriptures" is different from the generic privilege of all believers to appropriate the promises and blessings of relevant scriptures to areas of need in their lives. While there is nothing wrong with a believer scripture-shopping to claim promises or appropriate God's word for different areas of life, this is not the same as having a scripture or two that you are convinced about that actually describes your life and destiny. Such scripture(s) are not to be shopped for, but to be sought for because they are given by the Holy Spirit to you specifically as the prophecy of your life. Developing correct self awareness demands praying extensively till the Spirit of God deposits your "Life Scripture(s)" into your spirit. When you receive them, you hinge your life on it and use them as the true North of the compass of your life as you begin to align your consciousness and capacity development towards that direction.

Currently, I have two scriptures that are in this category with me. In this book, I will disclose one. ***Ps 105:22 says, "Joseph trained the king's officers the way he wanted and taught his respected leaders wisdom."*** (KJV says taught SENATORS wisdom).

Incidentally, I had not understood as much as I do now about my life purpose, assignment and direction, when Psa 105: 22 has always, for no obvious reason to me then, stood in my heart as a sign-post. I wrote this scripture down in my diaries for years, my spirit leaps and I prayed in the spirit each time I read it. I noted it in my spirit even when I did not fully understand what it meant to me. It took more than 10 years of knowing this was a life scripture for me, before I began to get into the understanding of what the scripture represents to me. Over a decade now, I have understanding that one of my primary life assignments is raising and mentoring leaders and my primary message is wisdom. So, basically in addition to the general requirements and proficiency of ministry, which every Kingdom believer, Christian minister/worker and Five-fold minister should be apt in, I am particularly a teacher/trainer and my primary message is wisdom for leaders across diverse sphere of influence: Church, marketplace, secular, spiritual etc. I got to know this at least 10 years after the Lord gave me the scripture for it. As a minister, you can practice, teach, preach, serve or function in other roles, but your "Life Scripture" will capture your life's cutting edge.

You can begin the journey into life clarity and success today by devoting yourself to waiting on the Lord to receive Life Scripture(s) if you do not have any already. However, there is a word of caution, A life scripture is not something you look for in a hurried search.

It is not something you window-shop for, but God gives to you out at His volition as you devote yourself to loving, seeking and walking with Him. In fact, if you are staying with God because you want Him to give you a Life Scripture that you can run away with, He most certainly will not attend to you yet. So, walk with God, fellowship and love Him, but stay open and release your faith for the scriptures or words that define your destiny now that you understand there is such a tool in God. Also, by all means, do not cook one or assume one for yourself. If you do, you will not see it manifest. God only confirms the Word He spoke, not the Word you assumed He spoke.

Life Scriptures

Your life statement is your life's job description based on your understanding of the prophecy or scripture that has gone ahead of you. It is the statement you write to describe yourself and what your life is all about. It is the vision and mission statement of your life based on your understanding of your identity, purpose and assignment. A very profitable exercise in life, is to write a 'simple statement' that describes what you believe your life is about. 'Simple statement' does not indicate simplicity in length or lexical construction, but non-complexion and in-ambiguity in meaning and interpretation.

Your "Life Statement" is a definition of what you believe your life and living is essentially about.

A great leader defined his life, statement thus: 'I live to help individuals maximize their personal potentials, including the transformation of followers into leaders and leaders into agents of change.' Another declared that his life is all about 'inspiring his generation to love God and making them understand the principles of God's Kingdom'.

So, back to the question; Who are You?'
Right Answer: Declare who you believe you will become based on Your what God has said about you. Use the present tense to describe your future based on your life assignment, purpose, highest potential and God's promises and prophesies to you in your Life Scripture.
Who are You?

Example:
I am a mentor, coach and trainer to; global leaders, high net-worth persons, high-profile executives, Marketplace Ministers, professionals, CEOs and government officials. I am a wisdom consultant to multi-national agencies, governments and organisations.

Who are You?
Write Your answer Here:

_____

_____

_____

_____

Success is when you fulfill what you just wrote now.

The first step in ascertaining the success of a course is to make sure it is the right course, as successfully completing the wrong task is still failure. It thus becomes important to spell out and write concise definitions that describe and guide your life-work.

Write Your Life Statement

Find a quiet place and think about your life and develop an essential definition for it. It is vital that your Life Statement is well articulated and written down. An unwritten Life Statement is simply non-existent, no matter how clearly it is conceived. It is also noteworthy that a single statement as the ones listed above may not come so easily for you. So, do not be too yoked with unnecessary perfectionism in crafting a life statement. Just write what you believe best describes what you know about your assignment for now and start working with what you have. Life has a way of unfolding when one is moving. Whatever you are able to write right now will do the great job of getting you started.

Furthermore, you should note that Life Statements are dynamic; what you write now may change with time as you understand more about your life. The written Life Statement is like a picture on a wall, far from sight as you move towards it, it becomes clearer and greater details begin to unfold.

Meditate and pray about your life in a secret place and write what you believe describes your life essence for now. Do not be under the pressure to precisely articulate the entirety of your lifespan in one statement. Such burdensome activity is simply unrealistic.

Of course, the Life Statement does not describe all one will do in life, but rather it provides a pivot around which all one does revolves. A great number of people are confused about life and purpose because they think that life purpose talks about an action, activity, job, profession, career or path. No! life statement assignment and purpose talk foremost about the mindset and consciousness which should be brought into the actions, activities, jobs, businesses, practices, careers or paths you engage. So, your Life Statement is not describing the one thing you will do with your life, rather, it portrays the mindset and understanding that governs and powers all the things you will do in life. Life will place many demands and needs, changing roles and tasks, different paths and multiple activities on you at different phases of you life. However, as you do all the different things at the different phases of life as occasion demands, your life statement should governs your attitude and conviction about yourself and your life in all that you do. Thereby, it provides the fulcrum around which your life revolves and stabilizes irrespective of changing scenarios.

A great number of people talk about how they have several abilities and do many things thereby not knowing which of them is their purpose or assignment.

Well, one can seemingly do many things, have different platforms created for different abilities and interests. One can work at different jobs, add value in different sectors based on different opportunities and phases of life. Clarity of purpose is knowing how everything one does, contributes to fulfilling your Life statement and assignment. You can be doing many things and still be focused as long as you can account for how all you do contributes to fulfilling the "Statement". Not understanding this simple but profound truth has made some people not to take any meaningful job leaving them to roam around in insolence, claiming that their purpose is not in those jobs. They think that purpose is one unilateral event and it talks about the one and only thing you will do in life. Working at a job, furthering your education, taking a course online or in school, acquiring a skill, building a business and even everyday things like spending time with loved ones becomes purposeful when you realize the role each play in fulfilling your life statement and assignment.

Personally, my current Life Mission Statement is 'to help and equip people fulfill their assignments and become leaders in their individual spheres of calling be it business, spiritual ministry, professional career or whatever field'. I believe my life assignment is to equip people to fulfil theirs. True success, for me, is when the people I equip succeed.

Life core values

It is important to define who you are and what your life is all about. It is equally important to define what you stand for in life. There must be crucial tenets upon which your life is founded. It is a true saying that the person who does not know what he/she stands for, would fall for anything. Life Core Values are the foundational codes of ethics upon which one's life is built on. They are the binding rules of life which you hold as a strong conviction and have a determination never to compromise. Having strong Life Values brings stability, and consistency with eventual predictability to your success in life. Great people are those who are prepared to stand for their life values, even if they will have to pay a price for doing so.

Life Core Values must also be written down. When Life Values are not predetermined and predefined, one will not be able to take a firm stand at some crucial points when life presents conflicting alternatives, compromising choices without prior notice. A lot of people make decisions or take alternatives which they later regret and wish they had not taken. Having Core Values that have been practiced over years, helps constitute a strong and sometimes, semi-conscious solid-cast mental system for decision making in daily living.

Examples of some great Life Core Values include; 'God-first-always', integrity, excellence, responsibility, self-reliance, financial independence, productivity, delayed-gratification, fidelity, chastity, morality, charity, kindness, friendliness, diligence, and many more which you can develop.

Do not make them too many so that you can imbibe them in your consciousness. Write between three to eight and practice them daily.

Life's fullest potential

Your life full potential is what you will attain, that you believe would define your life's highest point? It is the level at which you will be operating in your chosen endeavor, that you will believe you have reached your life's climax.

Material achievements are not the entire scope of success, however, attainments and achievements are very crucial in the success equation. Therefore, it is important to write down the heights you want to reach in life. For one in the academia, it may be when you become the Vice Chancellor of your institution or you establish a university of your own. For someone in business, it may be when your company generates a profit of a particular amount annually, or when you have a business installation in every continent. For a Kingdom financier it may be when you are able to give a particular figure monthly to partner with the work of the kingdom. No matter what you do, it is important to write what would describe your life's utmost accomplishment and to set it so high that you will need all the supply of God's help and miracles to achieve it. Whatever level you are right now, start working towards it. Having a vivid written and highly set life's fullest potential is one strategy to keep yourself driven when material success starts coming in.

Life Actualisation - Eternal Success

Life actualization is fulfilling the reason you were created by God. Unlike life's fullest potentials, actualization does not measure mere accomplishment, it measure purpose fulfillment. This is the reason it can only be determined by God on the other side of eternity.

One implication of the understanding of life in this discourse so far is the success or failure in life, can only be correctly determined at life's end. Additionally, eternal success or failure can only be determined on the other side of eternity. No matter one's attainments, achievements and acquisitions; without a successful ending, a life is reckoned as failed. Also, no matter the accomplishments in this life, without fulfillment of God's purpose for creating one and also making God's intended destination after life on earth, one has failed. This answers completely the question of people who do not know God and succeeded through self-discovery. They actually did not succeed if they go to hell after death or did not fulfill God's purpose and assignment for their life, no matter the material and financial accomplishment their lives recorded. Success is bigger than what many think. True success comprises of potential maximization, material success, self-actualization and fulfillment, as well as eternal success. Finishing well is the compulsory condition for a life of success and finishing well includes making eternity with God.

Who Will Cry When You Die?

An author wrote a book with a very interesting title; 'Who Will Cry When You Die?' This is unarguably a vital question. There are many things that seems so important and compete for people's attention in life, but at the final showdown, priorities change. One ultimate question remains, 'when you leave this earth, who are the people who will keep you eternally in their hearts and what will you be remembered for?' If you lived for impact and touched lives, you will live on in the hearts of people you blessed and be positively engraved in the chronicles of history. 'Who will cry when you die' is a question of impact. It measures your extent of living a life of meaning.

I find the title 'Who Will Cry When You Die?' intriguing and I believe that one of your goals in life should be to make as many as possible 'cry when you die'. Well, some may not cry literally, perhaps they are unemotional. The point being made is that you must live a selfless life of great difference, such that a number of people will be able to testify of the positive impact of your life on them when you die.

Will You Cry When You Die? A more important question and probably, a suggested title for another book is 'Will You Cry When You Die?' A traditional parable says, *"when children are born, they cry and the world rejoices. If they live well, when they die, they rejoice and the world cries.*

If they lived wrongly, when they die, they cry and the world rejoices". **In my limited time on earth, I have witnessed some people die in my country and multitudes took to the streets in joyful celebration. Will multitudes cry or rejoice when you die? Will you cry or rejoice when you die?**

After death, there is a place of rejoicing and a place of mourning. Irrespective of diverse opinions held by several people and with due respect to these people and their beliefs, the unshakable truth is that death is not the end, there is life after death. Eternal success is making it to heaven, the place of rejoicing after death. Eternal failure is finding one's self in hell, the place of crying, after death. It is in this context that the emphatic truth comes into play that no one can succeed outside of Jesus Christ. Contrary to some incorrect preaching, this does not mean that one cannot attain material, financial, professional or earthly success without faith in Jesus Christ. Obviously, there are many people who do not believe in Jesus Christ as savior, Lord and the Son of God that have great material success, live a purposeful life and make positive impact in the world. However, earthly success without making heaven is eternal failure.

Thus, no matter the success or failure of a person on earth, if anyone misses heaven, which is the fate of anyone that does not believe in Jesus Christ as Lord and Savior, such person has failed eternally.

1 John 5: 12 puts it amply, ***'He who has the Son has life; he who does not have the Son of God does not have life' (NIV).*** Life without Jesus Christ the Son of God is no life, it will end in failure. If you have never accepted Jesus as Saviour and Lord before, you need to do so by saying this prayer,

'Lord Jesus. I believe you are the Son of God who lived, died and resurrected for me. I ask you to come into my heart, make me a new person, accept me as yours and count me with those who will be with you in the Kingdom of Heaven. Amen.'

CHAPTER 4

The Life Assignment

There is a reason you are on earth, there is a need you are created to meet and a problem you are born to solve. Your Life Assignment is the reason you were created and born. Genuine success is discovering, training for, living and fulfilling your life assignment.

Success in today's world has been mostly defined in terms of material parameters. Material success have become not just a dream, but the whole essence of life for many persons. However, viewing success from a purely materialistic perspective is deceptive at best and dangerous at worst. While real success comes with a level of material attainment, it cannot be measured solely in terms of material possession. After salvation, which secure eternal success, true life success is best measured in terms of fulfilling one's **Life Assignment.**

The Need You Were Born to Meet

Your Life Assignment is the need God created you to meet. God does not do needless things and will not create anything without a need for it. Even science agrees that everything, both animate and inanimate, in the universe contributes a role to the sustainable inter-working of nature.

A vivid example of this is in respiration, where plants breathe in carbon dioxide to give off oxygen, which is taken in by animals to give off carbon dioxide; which is in turn breathed in by the plants. Also, in the biological system of living things, every part of the body has a function it plays in the overall functionality. The vitality of the heart, lungs, legs, hands and major organs are unquestionable, but even seemingly insignificant parts have an assignment in the body. Do you know that the hair on our body plays a role in insulation against heat and the eyebrows keeps sweat of the eyes? Even the appendix which has been said to play no role in the anatomy have been discovered by experts to have served a role when human diet was mostly vegetarian. Furthermore, more recent research has shown that the appendix currently plays a role in the human immune system. Nothing is created without purpose. God is very intentional and detailed. He who creates seemingly insignificant things for specific purposes and assignments, will definitely have a purpose for man, the height of His creation, who was created in his image and likeness.

From Adam and Eve, to every person thereafter, there is an existent need each person is assigned to fill. Gen 1: 26 is the scripture where man was mentioned for the first time in the Bible and it is in reference with an assignment. It reads, *God said, Let us make man in our image, after our likeness: and let them have dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over the cattle, and over all the earth, and over every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth* (Gen 1:26).

This scripture shows that the creation of man was necessitated by an assignment that God needed to be done - He needed someone to fill the role of an administrator over all His creation. Thus, without the need for a governor over the earth, there would have been no need for the creation of man. Man, by essence therefore, is a creature of assignment. This is one reason it is frustrating for people when they having nothing to do. Humans naturally cope with having too much to do, than with having nothing at all to do. We are created for doing the assignment. Have you noticed how frustrated people are when they are jobless and how self-destructive people become when they don't have anything gainful to do with their time? You were created to carry be busy with an assignment.

The Work You Were Born to Do

Gen 2:5-7,15 further explains the need for Adam's creation; *". . . No shrub of the field had yet appeared on the earth and no plant of the field had yet sprung up, for the Lord God had not sent rain on the earth and there was no man to work the ground . . . so The Lord God formed the man from the dust of the ground and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life, and the man became a living being . . . and The Lord God took the man and put him in the Garden of Eden to work it and take care of it."(NIV)*

There was a need for someone to tend the Garden of Eden so God took the man He had created and assigned him to the Garden.

A new chapter in life begins when you discover the existent need that was spotted by God when He created you and sent you on errand to the earth. There is a problem you were sent here to solve.

Identifying your Life Assignment

Some major principles of **'The Life Assignment'** is that your assignment must reveal the heart of God to people, solve problems for people and advance God's agenda on earth. One mistake people make is that when they think life assignment, they usually think in terms of career, job or activity. They think "Life Assignment" and they think, 'Am I to be a doctor, banker or lawyer'. Many times, Christians who sense a call into the ministry equally make the mistake of considering their life assignments in terms of ministry offices. They are quick to ask, 'Am I called to be an apostle, prophet, evangelist, pastor or teacher'. Life Assignment is not a career path or a ministry office. It is a job description.

The truth is that thinking in terms of career title or ministry appellation will not give you the right premise for discovering your life assignment. A better understanding of life assignment makes you think in term of assignment and task rather than titles, careers or offices. Thus, in discovering your life assignments. there are questions to reflect on. One distinguishing ability of successful people is the ability to ask the right questions.

Getting the right answer starts with asking the right questions. Some right questions to ask yourself regarding your life assignment include:

1. **What contribution do I believe I was created to make to my world and generation?'**
2. **What legacy do I want to be remembered for when I leave the earth?'**
3. **Whose lives will be testimonials that I lived?'**
4. **What will be my contribution to God's Agenda on earth before I transit to eternity?'**
5. **Who and how many people will be impacted because I lived?'**
6. **What sector of life or society is my life to affect?**
7. **What gap am I to fill in life and for what category of people?**
8. **What problem am I to solve and in what area of human life?**
9. **What task am I on earth to do for God?'**

The answers to these questions may not come easily, therefore, do not feel under pressure to answer them quickly. However, as you keep pondering, reflecting and most importantly, praying, about these questions in daily life and walk with God, you will eventually be led to fulfill your assignment.

Themes of Life Assignment

There are three central themes around a viable life assignment. They include God, a task, and a people. Thinking around these three themes bring clarity to your life assignment. Your life assignment is all about the task God sent you towards a particular people.

This understanding underscores the difference between career and assignment. While a career or ministry could be a vital platform for carrying out your assignment, it is not the assignment. Thus, becoming a doctor is not a life assignment or purpose, but believing you are sent by God to bring healing to the hurting through medicine is a life assignment. Being a political leader is not a life assignment, but knowing that you were created by God to bring integrity to the governance of a people, community or nation is a life assignment. Being a pastor or apostle is not a life assignment, but knowing that God has called you to get people saved and establish a local assembly where they will be nurtured to grow into all that God wants them to be is a life assignment. One could be a doctor and not fulfil his/her life assignment. One could be an apostle and be missing his/her life assignment. Your life assignment is to be thought about in terms of a task, message, and job description. Not a career path or a ministry appellation.

Other important elements of a life assignment are the location, duration, specificity and environment of the assignment. However, these all may change with time. The environment refers to the sphere of the assignment. The environment could be secular or spiritual, mundane or religious, business or informal.

God's Assignment

The first step in understanding your life assignment is to understand God's current assignment on the earth. Understanding God's assignment positions you to understand yours. God's assignment on the earth is summarized by this statement - the advancement of His Kingdom.

Every God-given life assignment, is a subset of God's great assignment of Kingdom advancement. The purpose of every one on earth is to deliver a work-package in the overall project God is executing on earth. Accurate understanding of Life-Assignment is elusive, until one thoroughly understands God's Assignment.

When people seek a life assignment outside the context of God's grand assignment, they unconsciously start working against the agenda of the One who assigned them to the earth. They are working contrary to their Life Assignment by working against God's purpose. There are people working against their created design and fighting the very course they were created to fulfill.

For example, a child was born and seemed naturally fabricated for musical excellence. This could be because God has spotted a need for someone who will take His presence in worship to a particular generation of people who can only be reached by the genre of music this person is gifted with by the Creator. However, such a person could grow up and become hijacked by the enemy. Since the gifting resident in him/her is a divine deposit, it will still be potent. So, the person becomes a global music star whose songs has highly promoted a culture of sexual immorality, violence and godlessness. He/she becomes a multimillionaire doing this, and becomes a role model of success in the world. However, such a person spent an entire lifetime working against their design. There is no greater failure than working against one's design. At life's end, such people will realize that they lived a life of total failure. Your assignment is to fulfill your part in God's Assignment. When all is said and done, every one will be appraised based on their contribution to God's Assignment. It is also noteworthy that God's agenda is not limited to spiritual or religious spheres - God is working something in every sector and industry of life. No matter how excellently one performs on the wrong task, one would be marked as failed. Succeeding at the wrong task is still failure. Your original Life Assignment is a subset of God's overall agenda. Therefore, if you can not state how what you are currently working at will contribute to God's heart for humanity, you are on the wrong task or probably, doing the right thing with the wrong understanding.

The first principle for attaining success from an eternal perspective is to get on God's side through Jesus Christ. However, accepting Jesus Christ does not automatically equate to fulfilling Life Assignment. It is possible for one to have accepted Jesus and still fail in Life Assignment. Faith in Jesus Christ for salvation is the important foundation but one must still discover the problem one was born to solve in whatever sphere of life they have been called to .

Indicators of your Life-Assignment

Assignment is time-bound. It is therefore not only important that you discover why you are here on earth but that you discover it on time. The earlier one discovers the assignment, the more time one has to fulfill it.

Pointers to the Assignment?

Some pointers have been popularly promulgated by self-help trainers in discovering one's life assignment. They emphasize the place of knowing your abilities, discovering your passion and gifts, identifying your heart-burden and painpoint. The heart-burden and painpoint is generally used to describe the area where you have a heart-seated concern for people and where you feel the weight of the wrongness of things, so much that you want to make them right even if the wrong doesn't affect you directly, it is what and where you care enough to want to address the issue.

Motivational speakers ask questions like, ‘what would you like to do even if you will not be paid for doing it?’ Someone once humorously answered this question by simply stating, ‘eat’.

Truly, these are pointers that are very helpful in self-discovery. Therefore, self-searching to discover these aforementioned pointers and answering the questions are valid and important . However, these pointers are not the path to assignment discovery. The way to discovering life assignment like self-discovery, is hinged on vibrant and close walk with God.

While it is beneficial to pay attention to your passion, gifts, burdens, and pain-points. The great truth remains that your assignment is in God and will unfold as a result of your walk with Him. These pointers may not absolutely lead you to your life assignment.

The truth is that God can give you an assignment in an area where you do not seem particularly to be gifted for and/or send you to a place you do not have a passion to go. We have seen preachers that are not good orators and business tycoons who do not seem smart. God loves to give people assignments that make you always need Him and sends you to a place where you will always be dependent on Him. Therefore, He can give you things you seem not to be naturally gifted for to do. This is the reason in identifying the Life Assignment, seeking God, not seeking pointers, is premium. A formula, recipe or equation promulgated by people for assignment discovery will not work, only the Spirit of God can lead you into your life assignment.

Somewhere lurking deep inside you is your assignment, waiting to find expression. Some people even unconsciously and without overly being spiritual, born-again or prayerful step into their activities that comprise their "Life Assignment." Such people perform greatly and succeed because what they do resonates with their natural essence. However, if they are not born again, they will still end up as eternal failures. It can not be over-emphasised that success without Jesus Christ is failure wearing the success camouflage.

CHAPTER 5

Working At The Assignment

The Life Work - Working the Life Assignment

You were sent to the earth on a mission. Identifying and deploying yourself for the mission(s) is what brings true fulfillment and success. Work is the term used to describe all efforts to deploy oneself profitably on earth. Therefore, God sent you to the earth to 'work'. However, God's concept of work is different from many people's concept. This chapter will give you the right understanding about work.

What You are Here to do ?

One of the most misunderstood concepts in life is the concept of work. Unemployment is a great challenge in many nations. People are either 'looking for work', 'out of work' or 'not working'. People also work tirelessly to put 'food on the table', people work because they have to be 'bread winners' and because of the scripture that says, **'whoever does not work should not eat.'** The subject of work is a serious discourse in understanding Life Assignment.

The first mention of the word 'work' with respect to man in the Scripture was in the Garden of Eden. The first man was created, given all the food, shelter and luxury he would ever need in the Garden.

Thereafter, he was given work to do. This is shown in Gen 2:8-16, ***Now the Lord God had planted a garden in the east, in Eden; and there he put the man he had formed. And the Lord God made all kinds of trees grow out of the ground — trees that were pleasing to the eye and good for food . . . The Lord God took the man and put him in the Garden of Eden to work it and take care of it.***

A logical question from the above scripture is, 'how do you give a man everything he needs for free and supply him with luxuries before you give him work?' Why does a man need to work when he already has everything he needs? The Truth is, people today except those that have an understanding of Life Assignment, will have no reason whatsoever to work anymore if they were given all that Adam had in the Garden. Giving man all he needs for food, shelter and satisfaction of needs, before giving him work shows that God's intention for creating work is not as a means for having food to eat, an instrument of survival and a tool for meeting material needs, however work was given to man for a greater purpose.

The Working for the Purpose of the Assignment

Gen 2:5-7 &15 reads, ***". . . No shrub of the field had yet appeared on the earth and no plant of the field had yet sprung up, for the Lord God had not sent rain on the earth and there was no man to work the ground . . . so The Lord God formed the man from the dust of the ground and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life, and the man became a living being . . . and The Lord God took the man and put him in the Garden of Eden to work it and take care of it."(NIV)***

You were created to work. Your purpose is linked to your work. Purpose discovery is work not a feeling. A lot of people pray for discovery of their assignments, attend classes and teachings on purpose discovery and do every other thing, except investing themselves in a profitable work venture. Such people never discover anything, no matter how hard they pray and meditate in the Spirit. In self-discovery, working at something as vital as, praying, meditating or even reading relevant books. Even if what you start working at is not ultimately your specific assignment, working triggers the mechanism for the intelligence of God to lead you into the specifics of your assignment. It is easier to turn the wheels of a moving vehicle than a stationary one.

Not working is the number one reason for not fulfilling purpose. Work is the instrument for assignment deployment, release of potential and wealth creation.

Working for Survival or Assignment?

While not working is devastating to destiny, working outside of purpose is frustrating and destructive. The difference between working for survival and working for purpose is discovering your "Life Assignment." The problem is that most of the work (job) people do in recent times are born out of the survival mentality and not assignment mentality.

People work just because they need to find anything to do to survive and they are quick to quote the Scripture that says, **He who does not work should not eat** (2 Thes 3:8-13 NLT).

The scripture truly says that he who does not work should not eat but it never said the reason for work is to eat (survive). The scripture was written because there were lazy people who were not willing to work but wanted to be living off social welfare, in the Church in Thessalonica. Paul therefore told them to learn from him how he never lived off charity and social welfare but worked diligently and had his needs met. The balance is that Paul was not working solely to have food to eat, but to win souls, impact nations and complete his Life Assignment. Having needs met and material sustenance is a by-product of work and not the reason for it – great people work tirelessly to build a destiny and fulfil their assignment. Laziness is one of the worst destroyers of destiny. The next destroyer of destiny to laziness is working diligently with a survival mentality. All those who have impacted the world and fulfilled their life assignments are diligent workers, but they had a higher purpose for what they are doing, than the need to have food to eat, bills to pay rent, food to wear. It is a curse to work just for food to eat. You must have something that matters in life and destiny that you are trying to achieve with every work you do. If you have not yet discovered anything of significance to your destiny in what you are doing other, than it gives you a salary to survive on, you need to start praying to God to reveal the relevance of what you are currently doing to your destiny. If there is no relevance whatsoever, God will answer your prayers by re-routing the course of your life into what you need to be doing now.

At creation, man didn't work for food (Gen. 2:9, 16). Man worked at his assignment because that was the reason for his existence.

Working for the purpose of having food to eat and needs to meet came after the fall of man. Jesus came to restore us from the fallen state of man. So, Jesus did not work solely to have needs met. He worked because He had a destiny to fulfill, a mission to accomplish, a people to help and a legacy to create. Jesus said, *"My Father is always working, and so am I. John 5:17 NLT.* You must exert and deploy yourself in diligent work to fulfill the vision God has given you.

It should be noted that it is legitimate to take up work in other to have one's needs met. Truly, your work should enable you fend for yourself and your family. However, the point is that you cannot live with that mindset as the entire reason you are working. If this is all one is thinking about as he or she works tirelessly, such a person is in bondage. Take up work and jobs based on where you are going in life.

Types of Work

The correct concept of work sees work as anything you exact yourself at to create your future, prepare for and/or fulfill your assignment, create wealth, generate resources for life sustenance towards the assignment, achieve your goals and fulfill your life purpose. Work is a timeless principle for man on earth. This is the reason unemployment is not just financial problem, it deteriorates the emotional well-being, self-confidence and spiritual health of 'the jobless'.

You don't want to put your self in a position of joblessness. So, go out; there is work.

It is noteworthy that the difference between working for survival and working for assignment is in the mindset and perspective of the worker and not necessarily in the exertion of work. Both the assignment worker and the survival worker, most times are doing the same thing but with different mental approaches. Thus, their life results are different. Two different people can be employed in the same work, doing the same thing. One with a survival mindset and the other with an assignment mindset.

In today's world, there is entrepreneurial work and intrapreneurial work. Entrepreneurial work is work initiative taken by someone to create or sell value to meet a felt need in others and thereby generate profit. Entrepreneurship is when someone takes personal initiative, starts up a venture or organisation, or partners with like-minded people to meet an identified need in the market and make profit doing so. Entrepreneurs manages resources, risk and opportunities to create a business or company, to sell a product or service to a target market. Founders of organisations (profit or non-profit) are generally entrepreneurial workers. Entrepreneurial work is a great deal of hard-work, because one has to deliver results without anyone to drive or manage. Entrepreneurs must be self-driven workers.

Intrapreneurial work is using new and innovative ideas to advance an existing organisation, thereby enhancing the organisation's profitability and generating rewards for yourself. Recently, more businesses are engaging a model of intrapreneurship where workers in an organisation determine how much they earn and how far they go by their unique value addition and contribution to the organisational bottom-line.

An intrapreneur enjoys the benefits of entrepreneurship within a larger organisation, thereby absolving him of the risk associated with him starting up a company. When an organisation systemically allows its workers to apply an entrepreneurial mindset to their job within a company, it s using intrapreneurial techniques. It is important to know how to be an intrapreneur within an organisation and also important for leaders to know how to develop an intrapreneurial mindset and not merely an employee mindset in their workers.

Intrapreneurs are employees but not all employees are intrapreneurs. Intrapreneurs are innovative people who engage entrepreneurial drive and creativity to expand the profitability of an organisation where they are employed, even though they are not the founders. It is important to differentiate between employees who simply are employee-minded and those who are intrapreneurs. Employee-minded people, many times, are security seekers, who carry out task allotted to them in an organisation and seeks a salary which should cover their needs. They most times do not have self-initiative or vision, they do just enough to stay employed, because they do not want to lose the job as it gives them a source of livelihood. Intrapreneurs have a vision and they see the opportunity to fulfill it while working in another person's vision.
It is important to understand that both entrepreneurial and intrapreneurial work is profitable. Fulfilling your assignment demands that you either work in an existing organisation or start an organisation. Starting up anything of value is a great deal of work and involves a great amount of risk. It is not everyone that has developed the capacity to succeed at entrepreneurial ventures.

Some people in a misguided notion that they should not work for another person or organisation but be 'their own boss', lie all day doing nothing and going nowhere. What you need right now in fulfilling your life assignment may be to take up a job in another person's vision. It gives you the opportunity to learn and grow. It is gives the privilege of having consistent income to build your financial future. It supplies resources both tangible and intangible, to prepare and invest in your life assignment. Both entrepreneurial and intrapreneurial work is good at different phases of life. Thus, the scripture says, *in all labor there is profit, but idle chatter leads only to poverty*. (Prov 14:23 NKJV)

On the other hand, working with a mere employee-mindset, which is most times a mindset of servitude and survival through salary and wages, is detrimental to destiny. What the recent emphasis on people going into entrepreneurship and not being employed under someone else should try to do is to damage is the unhealthy 'employee mindset' in people and not make it look as if everyone should leave their jobs and go startup something. Statistically, 95% of business start-ups fail and as a matter of fact, most people that start-up business, especially in Africa, are not entrepreneurs but self-employed people.

Knowing the advantages of entrepreneurship versus intrapreneurship, the difference between a business owner and a self-employed person and the qualities to develop for different work types is outside the scope of this book. Therefore, it is important go out of your way to do a personal research on the details of each type of work and discover which is best-suited for you.

Work and Job

Understanding the concept of work thus makes us understand that being employed at a job is not contrary to life assignment. In fact, it could be necessary to discover one's assignment, learn and develop skills, prepare for one's vision and even get finances to sustain oneself while discovering, developing and fulfilling purpose. It could also bring in some capital to contribute to funding one's assignment. However, working at a job (career, business or ministry) with a survival mentality sucks life out of a destiny. It is good to get a good job, it is also much better to also discover your life assignment. The two can run concurrently. However, if the two clashes, your assignment is superior to the good job.

Life would be more meaningful if people spent as much time discovering, investing into and pursuing their life work as they spend looking for jobs. The balance, has already established earlier, is that discovering your Life Assignment and Life Work does not mean that you may not have to take up a job. While paying bills, having food to eat and meeting needs is not the essence of working in life, working to make ends meet is a legitimate reason in today's world although it is not the ultimate reason. Therefore, as you work at a job to learn and earn a sustenance, seek to discover your life work and start working diligently at it.

Your life work, is the work you are doing in line with your life assignment. This work is a lifetime venture and no employer can fire you from it. Careers can collapse and people can lose jobs, but when you discover your life work, you always have a reason to wake up and exert yourself productively. Fulfillment comes when what you do daily is aligned to your life work.

It is most crucial for those that have a job that is not specifically their life assignment to still exert themselves in a work that is their life assignment. This could be a for profit, non-profit, ministry-related work or an investment portfolio you are building to enable you do the things that matter to your life and destiny later. Get involved in something that you know is the essence and purpose of your life while you are still at that job that you know is not the entire essence of your life.

Many Activities - One Task

Finally, on "Life Assignment and Work," it is important to know that there are many things one will do on earth. The concept of life assignment is not an attempt to say that there is one singular thing that you do with life, to the exclusion of every item in life. Some people have erroneously thought that life assignment means that there is one thing you will pursue and face in life. This misunderstanding has become the undoing and failure of many 'purposeful and assignment-conscious fanatics'.

As usually said, one could fall into a ditch on either side of the road. One extreme is found in those that pursue survival and security in life, with no thought of the higher purpose of Life Assignment. The other extreme is found in people who have become irresponsible and unrealistic with everyday life and do nothing to make a decent living for self-dependence in the name of pursuing something higher with their lives.

There has been a noted trend of pragmatic irresponsibility with working to meet up with the everyday expenditure and demands of life, among those who seem to have a particular passion thay see as the essence of their lives.

There have been people who believe their life assignment is related to a particular expression of art, music, sport, passion or spiritual ministry and they literally become irresponsible in every other area of life except the singular activity of that vocation. This in itself is a gross misconception of life assignment. I was particularly pained once when I met on the streets, one of my seniors in the university who we knew to be very given to spiritual pursuits to the exclusion of academics and regular work some years after I had graduated. He walked to me, gave me a spiritual greeting and talked about how he came for a church meeting in town and needed money to get back to his base. I respected his spiritual passion, but I knew he could be as passionate for spiritual things as he was and still take responsibility in other areas of life. I gave him some money because I knew and trusted him.

The fact that one's life assignment is to be a musician, does not mean that such as person should only sing and sit on a musical instrument all day. Life is a holistic system with many components. Your life assignment is your life's cutting edge, but it is not your life's singular activity. Going to school to study a course, learning a tradable skill, volunteering in projects, developing streams of income, working at a job, building and keeping healthy relationships, building and fending for your family are integral parts of life. No structure stands sustainably on one leg - life also stands on many legs.

A person may be called to be a musician, artist, sportsperson, gospel minister etc. This may also be his/her life assignment. But that does not mean that is the entirety of the activity he/she should do.

You should successfully study a course, work at a business, ministry or organisation, build a family and do things that build your life holistically to sustain you in carrying out the life assignment.

There have been people who believe they are called to be musicians, who do not take their academics serious, do not take their finances serious, are not willing to work at a job or build a business, but just want to sing and rehearse all day long. They are not equipped and prepared to meet the demands of everyday life. So, though they are excellent singers and musician, they still live deficient lives. It is most painful when this is done by people who believe they are called into the ministry and only want to do spiritual things all day long and become irresponsible in other areas of life. It is a misunderstanding of life assignment that misrepresents God. People look at them and ridicule God, not knowing that He is not happy with how they are living. God can sincerely call one into ministry, but at the same time the wisdom to know how to go about it takes adequate teaching, training and mentoring.

Your life assignment is the assignment of your life. So, you need to have a life before you have a life assignment. So work diligently on every area of your life and then assign that life toward the fulfillment of the assignment. Financial well-being, family upkeep, mental and academic development, means of income, spiritual, social and physical health are all vital components of life. People that neglect the components of life to be preoccupied about life assignment, often come short of fulfilling purpose and become a reproach to the aspiration they claim to pursue.

You must pay attention to every area of your life. And do all that needs to be done to make a success of your life. The issue of success in life assignment is balancing all the components and areas of your life and not pursuing something to the detrimental neglect of all else. You will do many things, but they must all eventually revolve around the assignment.

Your "Life Assignment" is the central theme in the story of your life. It is the determinant of your life-matrix and the core around which all life-decisions must revolve. You will do many things in life, but you must be able to account for how each contributes to your 'Life Assignment', education, career, ministry, marriage, relationships, money, religion and every other item. Life takes up accurate meaning when life assignment is understood.

CHAPTER 6

Understanding The Kingdom

God has an assignment for everything He created. Nature, spirits, humans, all living things and inanimate objects are all created for specific functions in God's agenda. According to Col 1:16, ***for through him God created everything in the heavenly realms and on earth. He made the things we can see and the things we can't see such as thrones, kingdoms, rulers, and authorities in the unseen world. Everything was created through him and for him*** (NLT). Everything and everyone exist for God's purpose. Therefore, the assignment of everything and everyone on earth is found in what God's grand purpose on earth is. God merely creates and delegates to each person, a role to fulfill in His overall purpose. Thus, the understanding of Life-Assignment is elusive until one thoroughly understands God's Assignment. This chapter on "Understanding the Kingdom of God" will clearly explain God's assignment, so you can thereby know your place and purpose in God's grand assignment.

God's Assignment - The Kingdom

God is the King and His Kingdom is established throughout all eternity. God sits supreme in Heaven, from where He rules the Kingdom. The reign of God is undisputed in heaven. It is only on earth that the reign of God. The Kingdom of God, is in question, because Man, His viceroy, lost the Kingdom.

The singular work of God on the earth is restoring the earth - the world and all that is in it, to His Kingdom. The word 'Kingdom' means 'king's domain'. It is the domain where a kingdom rules or reigns. The Kingdom of God is the realms of God's reign.

The kingdom of God does not refer to a church or religion, it is the governing influence of God over a territory, run by His principles, impacted with His will, purpose and intents, and producing a people who express His culture and reflect His nature. Thus, the Kingdom of God is used to describe any territory, place, person, system, organisation, business, or nation that is ruled under the recognition of the Lordship of the Person of Jesus, by the principles of the Word of God, and whose lives express a culture that depicts the character of God. An individual, family, business, enterprise, institution, ministry, political state, country, or territory can be the Kingdom of God. Thus, Luke 17: 20 - 21 records, ***now when He was asked by the Pharisees when the kingdom of God would come, He answered them and said, "The kingdom of God does not come with observation; nor will they say,'See here!' or 'See there!' For indeed, the kingdom of God is within you."*** Luke 17:20-21 NKJV.

The Kingdom of God is intangible and it is inherently contained, transmitted, expressed and promulgated by persons and systems. Your purpose on earth is to propagate God's Kingdom. Your "Life Assignment" is to carry out a task that God has given you in a sphere of life, nd by so doing impose, promulgate and establish God's Kingdom; His Lordship, dominion, rule and reign, in your world.

God's Assignment - The Kingdom

When people understand the great Kingdom Assignment of God, they become purposeful in life. They cease to be confused about why they exist and know what to do with their lives.

God is the Creator of all things therefore, He has the right to rule over all. Thus, the Kingdom of God spans all things, places and realms in eternity. However, not all persons, places, systems and things are under the experiential reign of God through submission and compliance to His will and ways.

This is aptly captured by Ps 115:16 when it says, *the heavens belong to the Lord, but he has given the earth to all humanity*. God is King over all things and kingdoms, but He benevolently delegated the kingdom of the earth to man. Thus, all happening on the earth are not as a result of God's sovereignty, but man's determination. This explains the fact that the many wrong things happening in different sectors of nations, communities, people's lives are not God's making. They are as a result of the fact that the Kingdom of God is not reigning in those areas.

Matt 6:10, says, *thy kingdom come. Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven.* Thus, God's Kingdom comes upon an individual, system or territory when His will is being done therein. Such a person, place or system becomes an outpost of heaven. As currently, God's will is not fully done over nations, societies, institutions, politics, education, churches, economies, homes and individuals, the "Life assignment" of every kingdom citizen is to bring an assigned sphere under the Kingdom reign.

Do you know that many of the things you have been complaining in nations, schools, societies, churches, economies, families are reflections of undone assignments of Kingdom citizens. When we take our place fully and completely, the kingdoms of the world will become the Kingdom the Lord and His Christ (Rev 11: 15). You were born to bring a particular sphere of humanity and world system under the reign of God's Kingdom.

The Kingdom Story

God is the King of the Kingdom. When Satan, led some created beings, to rebel and set up a parallel kingdom, he and his cohorts were sent on exile, plunged into eternal darkness and damned to destruction. All these predated the existence of man.

Therefore, the book of Genesis in the Bible opens with a record of God re-instating a kingdom on the earth with man as a regent under God. The earth was an outpost of Heaven and God and man, connected to God by the Holy Spirit, was to rule over the Kingdom of the earth. He was to express God's will, culture, principles and nature, in the world by the Spirit of God in Him. Man was the crown king over the kingdoms of the world and he was to rule under the authority of God, His King.

When Satan told man to disobey God and carry out his instruction to eat the fruit of knowledge of good and evil. It was not merely an issue of eating fruits and the repercussions of eating. It was a kingdom clash, one of the principles of the kingdom is that '. . . *to whom you present yourselves slaves to obey, you are that one's slaves whom you obey . . .' (Rom 6:16).*

Man, the king, has become the slave and the slave, satan, has become king through guile. Prov 30: 21 - 22 mentions four things that is unbearable on the earth. The first is when a slave becomes king. All the evil in the world is because satan became king and had man as his slave, executing his will upon the earth. The Kingdom of God on earth has been subjugated by the kingdom of darkness due to the carelessness of man - God's Ambassador to the kingdom of the earth.

Every kingdom is ruled by the principles of the King over it and reflects the nature and character of its king. Thus, every the wrongs on earth are a reflection of the nature of satan, sickness, poverty, murder, immorality, wars (political, international, economical, religious, between labour capital etc.) God's assignment is to reclaim the entire earth; the people, the world and all its systems, the sectors and eventually the physical earth, from the effects of the rule of satan over it.

This is why Jesus came The Eternal King was sent to the earth to help rescue his enslaved regent and to reclaim and re-institute His Kingdom on the earth. He came as a Man into the enemy conquered earth, defeated satan and all his cohorts both on the physical realms of the earth and spiritual realms of the underworld. He took the keys of dominion and handed it back to man and ascended back to heaven, having restored man as king.

However, man has been slave for millennia, so he does not know how to be king anymore. Jesus, in his earthly time on earth had displayed what kingdom over satan, demons, sickness, poverty, elements of the earth and the world system looks like.

So, part of that was documented as a kingship training manual for man to rediscover himself. However, more vitally, the Spirit of the King, which man lost at the beginning was restored to Him into the fullness of his inheritance as king of the kingdom of the earth and to empower him by bringing all things and sectors of the earth under his rule.
However, all these Kingdom transactions were consummated in the spiritual realm. It takes understanding of what has happened and deliberately imposing it to see it manifest in the physical world.

A great percentage of humans do not know this story, so they continue to live under the slavery of the illegal king who has been conquered and deposed. However, satan succeeded in building a strong system that runs on ideologies and cultures to propagate his reign over man. So, he still rules over many men, systems and nations. Though, he has been defeated, he rules over them through their ignorance of what has been done and also through the systemic structure of thought patterns, cultures, practices and systems that has worked over the years into every sector of life on the earth.

Thus, total Kingdom reclamation involves:

1. Getting people from under the dominion of satan, this is done through salvation. Therefore, any venture or systems that gets people saved is advancing the kingdom.

2. Re-orienting people to know and become their true identity by liberating them from worldly and satanic ideological strongholds and mind control. Thus, kingdom advancement involves any system, secular or religious, that seeks to change how people think and live from worldly/satanic to Godly. These platforms can take the form of churches, schools, institutes, hospitals, programs, businesses etc that target changing people's world view and perspective from satan-influence paradigm to God-influenced paradigm is advancing the Kingdom.

3. Reclaiming all the sectors and systems of life on earth through culture shift and bringing all spheres and systems of life from the bondage of satan, into alignment with the kingdom of God. Thus, taking over sectors and spheres of influences and changing the governing principles by which these systems are run from those at satan, to that of God is Kingdom advance. This is possible when a Kingdom person takes dominion in those system and imposes the reign of the kingdom he represents over those areas. Thus, taking over the political, economical, financial, academic, family, heath, military and other terrains of your communities and nations and bringing in under the dominion of Christ is Kingdom Advancement.

Your Life assignment is to locate the area among the above listed that God has apportioned you a role and to play the part you are allocated.

The Spheres of the Kingdom

Summarily, the Kingdom of God consists of :

1. **The Kingdom of Heaven** where the reign of God is uncontested because His will is perfectly done.

2. **The Kingdom of Darkness,** which describes the realm of Satan and his cohorts which have been judged and are destined for destruction.

3. **The Kingdom of the Earth.** The earth talks about the physical structure which houses the people and all things on it. The world talks about the system of people, and activities on earth. Thus the **Kingdom of the World** is the social order of all things on the earth. Thus, the main interest of both God and satan on the earth is the **Kingdoms of the World** (Rev. 11: 15). The physical earth itself was created by God with a tenure and will be destroyed and a new earth will be created (Rev 21: 1).

The Spheres of the Kingdom of the Earth

Your life assignment is to advance the Kingdom in a particular area and way, by making a unique contribution to God's reclamation of the earth, its people, its cultures, systems and principles. You were created, born again and the Holy Spirit of God was given to you, for you to know, be trained and empowered for the spheres that you are to reclaim for God's Kingdom. When you know what you are to contribute, in which sphere of human endeavour and life sector to function and how to do it, such that the Kingdom of God is introduced, propagated, advanced or

imposed on the kingdom of the world, thereby dispelling the kingdom of darkness in a sphere of influence, using your platform, you have understood and identified your life assignment and Purpose.

There are many areas of the world crying for Kingdom reclamation, The entire world runs by innumerable and inexhaustible number of spheres and sectors. However, for sake of Kingdom trainers, I have recently classified them into the popularly described seven mountains of influence, which include:

1. Government/Governance - Politics, Law, Military, Civil Service, etc.

2. Media -- Writing, TV Shows, Journalism, News, Information, Broadcasting, Social Media

3. Finance/Business/Economy - Banking, Corporations, Commerce etc.

4. Arts and Entertainment - Music, Drama, Comedy, Fashion, etc.

5. Education

6. Family and Relationships

7. Religion and spirituality

Even though, this list is not absolute, it gives a fair impression of the fact that you can look through the classifications and look at the area(s) where you believe you have a calling and assignment and start the life journey to raise the banner of the Kingdom of God in those spheres(s).

CHAPTER 7

Fulfilling Purpose

The most important thing you can do in life is to pursue and fulfil God's purpose for you. After salvation, the most important discovery in life is the purpose for which you were created and saved.

Living Purposefully

This is the reason it is important to live by all Kingdom principles; add those that make for purpose fulfillment to those that make for wealth, prosperity and material success.

Purpose is primarily a mindset, an understanding, an attitude towards life and all life activities that seeks, factors how to and actively does things to advance God's Kingdom in any sphere you find yourself, because you believe that is the reason you are positioned there. Purpose is an attitude towards that understands the sphere of the Kingdom that one has been assigned to take for Christ and engages in every life activity with that singular goal in mind.

When you make every decision, take every step and do everything with fulfilling your Kingdom as the priority viewpoint you are walking in purpose. Purpose is not a destination or an event, it is a mindset. Everything you do as your contribution and partnership with God to fulfill your discovered assignment is walking in line with God's purpose for your life.

For this reason, schooling could be done in purpose or out of purpose, building a business could be done in purpose or out of purpose, getting married could be in purpose or out of purpose. Working at a job could be in purpose or out of purpose. For instance, if a person's life assignment is to ignite a spiritual revival that will lead to a mass entrance of individuals into God's kingdom through evangelism and such a person is working in a bank, that person is not living according to God's purpose. If a person's life assignment is to build an educational institution that will save, mentor and build as many as will be part of the system and such as person takes a job as a full-time staff in a church or pastor, diligently working to 'serve God', such a person is out of purpose.

Purpose is determined by the manufacturer, it is God who determines the role he wants you to play in His Kingdom. Do not be brainwashed into thinking some roles are more spiritual than others. If the role is from God, it is spiritual even if it is on a secular platform.

Types of Purpose

God has an eternal purpose He is working out and this purpose is His Kingdom. Eph 3:11 shows that we are all called ***according to the eternal purpose which He purposed in Christ Jesus our Lord.*** God's purpose is the advancement of Kingdom and every believer has a sub-assignment within God's Kingdom as their individual purpose.

God's purpose can be seen from two perspectives:

1. **The Generic Purpose of All Believers -** God's general purpose for believer includes the assignments that are general to every child of God irrespective of their individual spheres of callings and platforms.

(i) Kingdom Advancement through evangelism and discipleship of persons, institutions, territories, nations (Matt. 28: 19 -20). Every child of God should be involved in evangelism and discipleship irrespective of whether they are called to the five-fold ministry or not.

(ii) Kingdom culture alignment of persons, institutions, territories, nations (Rev. 11: 15). Every child of God must be involved in aligning the culture of their spheres of influence, neighborhood and communities to God through godly representation in daily life. This involves challenging norms that are ungodly, addressing vices and mindsets contrary to God. This is the correctional ministry of the church against all that is evil in the world. You have a purpose in the Kingdom to stand for what is right and to straighten out the culture of your community.

(iii) Worship of the King (Rev. 4: 11). Every child of God has a purpose to worship God and raise the banner of His name.

(iv) Glorifying King through our Results. (Matt. 5: 16,John. 15: 8)

Every believer has the duty to bring glory to God through good works, success, and superior results over the world system etc.

2. **The Specific Purpose of Each Believer -** Each believer has a specific platform where he is most suited for advancing God's Kingdom. Purpose discovery as popularly taught is actually the discovery of the platform where you are meant to carry out God's purpose for your life.

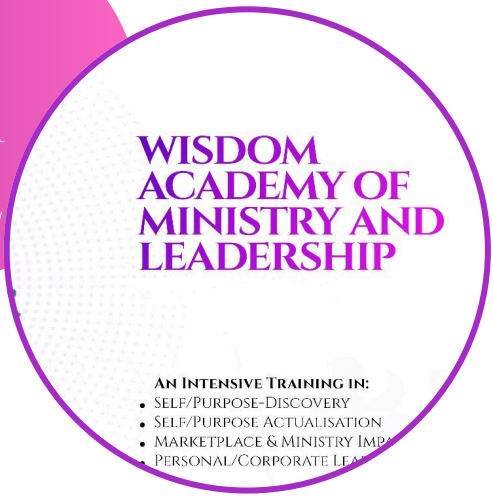
In Jer. 1: 5 - 10, we see that Jeremiah had a specific purpose in the prophetic office. For someone else, it may be in education, finance, politics, media etc.

A believer can have a Kingdom purpose to fulfill in the following spheres of influence. Some may have influence in more than one sphere due to their Kingdom positioning. The list of spheres of Kingdom purpose is endless however, they have been recently categorised in seven categories:

1. Government/Governance - Politics, Law, Military, Civil Service, etc
2. Media -- Writing, TV Shows, Journalism, News, Information, Broadcasting, Social Media.
3. Finance/Business/Economy - Banking, Corporations, Commerce etc.
4. Arts and Entertainment - Music, Drama, Comedy, Fashion, etc.
5. Education
6. Family and Relationships
7. Religion - Church and Para-church

Prayerfully discover where you are called to play a role for God. Know what you want to achieve for your Kingdom in that sphere and go all out to fulfill this task. You are always walking in God's purpose for you life.

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ABOUT THE BOOK

The Life Assignment provides insights into the ultimate reason for human existence. Gripping life questions like 'who am I?', 'what am I on earth to do?', 'why do I exist?' and 'how do I actualise and fulfil my Life Purpose and Assignment?' are clarified and answered. This book will help you discover, define, understand and deploy yourself for a fulfilling and rewarding life.



ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Davids Oluwaseye Ayodele is a trainer, speaker and writer. He is graced with understanding and presenting complex issues with simplicity and clarity for practical application.

He is the founder of several initiatives both within the Church and the workplace such as The Wisdom Institute of Leadership and Ministry for training and equipping Church leaders, ENABLED Multiconcept for business and professional leadership development and consultancy, and several other platforms for Bible-based Teaching Ministry. He has a bachelor's degree in chemical engineering and master's degree in engineering management from Ahmadu Bello University, Nigeria. He is married to Deborah OluwaNifemi and they are blessed with children.